



Why Not Carry A Pen Drive Instead?

Carry it wherever you go. Boot from any computer. Have your data along with personalised system settings available anywhere, with negligible additional weight in your pocket... That's what Linux on your pen drive offers.

In this tutorial, we will install five different Linux distributions on a pen drive. My shortlist is Slax, Damn Small Linux (DSL), GoblinX, Puppy Linux and Pen Drive Linux. Of course, you can choose to have something else.

Let's start off with the requirements:

- A Fat16-formatted pen drive. Except for Puppy Linux and DSL, which would happily install on a 512 MB drive, I would recommend a pen drive of 1GB or more. Mine is a 4 GB (U3 removed) pen drive.
- ISOs of Puppy Linux and DSL, the tar package for Slax, GoblinX and Pen Drive Linux zip packages for USB. Download the latest versions for up to date software.
- A motherboard BIOS that is capable

of booting from USB drives. Most motherboards from 2004 onwards have this feature. This is not necessary if you decide to use PuppyLinux.

- Any version of Linux installed. I use openSUSE 11.

Points to remember before getting started:

- Before using your pen drive, back up whatever data is in it, as it may get deleted.
- If you decide to install on a U3 drive, you must remove the U3 software before you decide to install. Check out U3 removable tools from www.u3.com/uninstall.

Getting your pen drive ready

Your pen drive needs to be Fat16 formatted. Use GParted, *cfdisk*, or any other partition tool for the purpose.